# Indian Farmer Guide 2026

## Government Schemes, News, FAQs, and Agricultural Advisories

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## Executive Summary

This comprehensive guide provides Indian farmers with essential information about government schemes, recent policy developments, frequently asked questions, and critical agricultural advisories for 2026. The document consolidates resources from central government agencies, agricultural universities, and the India Meteorological Department (IMD) to support better farming decisions and maximize benefits from available programs.

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# 1. MAJOR GOVERNMENT SCHEMES FOR FARMERS

## 1.1 Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-Kisan)

**Scheme Overview**

- Annual income support of ₹6,000 for small and marginal farmers
- Payment made in three equal installments of ₹2,000 each via Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)
- Completely transparent with no middlemen involvement
- Currently benefiting over 9.8 crore farmers[1]

**Key Benefits**

- Assured annual income support regardless of crop performance

- Direct transfer to Aadhaar-linked bank account
- Funds can be used for seeds, fertilizers, household expenses, or debt repayment
- Predictable financial support every four months

**Eligibility Criteria**

- Indian citizens with cultivable land
- Small and marginal farmers
- Valid Aadhaar linked to active bank account
- Must have completed e-KYC verification
- Not applicable to income tax payers or government employees with higher salaries

**Important 2026 Update**

- 22nd installment expected around February 2026
- 23rd installment expected around May-June 2026
- Mandatory e-KYC and Farmer ID registration for all beneficiaries
- Farmers without completed e-KYC may face payment delays

**How to Apply**

- Visit official PM-Kisan website (pmkisan.gov.in)
- Register through Common Service Centres (CSC)
- Contact local Agriculture Department office

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## 1.2 Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)

**Scheme Overview**

- Crop insurance protection against natural calamities, pests, and diseases
- Coverage includes crop failure due to floods, droughts, hailstorms, and weather disasters
- Simplified claims settlement with remote-sensing technology[2]

**Premium Rates**

- Kharif crops: 2% of insured amount

- Rabi crops: 1.5% of insured amount
- Commercial/horticulture crops: 5% of insured amount
- Government bears remaining premium amount

**Key Benefits**

- Direct payout to farmer's bank account
- Quick compensation after crop loss
- Weather-based insurance system
- Faster claim settlement using mobile apps and remote sensing

**Expected 2026 Improvements**

- Faster claim processing
- Simplified procedures
- Enhanced weather-based insurance mechanisms
- Timely compensation during natural disasters

**How to Apply**

- Online at PMFBY portal (pmfby.gov.in)
- At time of crop loan through banks
- Through Common Service Centres (CSC)
- Direct contact with insurance agents

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## 1.3 Kisan Credit Card (KCC)

**Scheme Overview**

- Revolving credit facility for short-term agricultural needs
- Covers crop production, livestock, dairy, and fisheries activities
- Provides flexible credit with subsidized interest rates[3]

**Benefits**

- Effective interest rate of approximately 4%
- Flexible repayment options aligned with harvest seasons
- Coverage for allied farming activities
- Quick loan disbursement

**Eligibility**

- Farmers engaged in agricultural production
- Those with valid land ownership records
- Agricultural laborers and tenant farmers

**How to Apply**

- Public sector and private sector banks
- Cooperative banks and PACS (Primary Agricultural Credit Societies)
- Selected bank websites

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## 1.4 Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY) - Per Drop More Crop

**Scheme Overview**

- Irrigation infrastructure development and micro-irrigation promotion
- Focus on water conservation and efficient water use
- Subsidizes drip and sprinkler irrigation systems[2]

**Subsidy Structure**

- Small and marginal farmers: 55% subsidy
- Other farmers: 45% subsidy
- Over 95 lakh hectares already covered

**Key Benefits**

- Reduces water usage by up to 50%
- Increases crop yield and productivity
- Particularly effective for water-intensive crops (sugarcane, cotton)
- Subsidy credited via Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)

**How to Apply**

- State irrigation departments
- District agriculture offices
- Agricultural cooperatives

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## 1.5 PM KUSUM (Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha Utthaan Mahabhiyan)

**Scheme Overview**

- Solar pump and grid-connected solar panel program
- Financial assistance up to 60% subsidy plus 30% bank loan
- Enables farmers to generate additional income through power generation[4]

**Financial Structure**

- 60% subsidy from government
- 30% bank loan at attractive rates
- 10% to be borne by farmer

**Key Benefits**

- Zero diesel costs for irrigation
- Electricity generation on fallow land
- Potential earning of ₹50,000-₹70,000 annually from surplus power sale to DISCOMs
- Contribution to renewable energy targets

**How to Apply**

- State renewable energy departments
- District agriculture offices
- MNRE (Ministry of New and Renewable Energy) portal

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## 1.6 Soil Health Card Scheme

**Scheme Overview**

- Free soil testing for all farmers
- Individual soil analysis with crop-specific recommendations
- Scientific approach to fertilizer and nutrient management[3]

**Key Benefits**

- Reduced fertilizer costs through precise recommendations

- Improved soil fertility and structure
- Higher crop productivity through optimized nutrient application
- Better soil health for sustainable farming

**Information Provided**

- Soil nutrient status (NPK - Nitrogen, Phosphorus, Potassium)
- Secondary and micronutrient levels
- Crop-wise fertilizer recommendations
- Soil pH and organic matter content

**How to Obtain**

- District soil testing laboratories
- State agriculture departments
- Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs)

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## 1.7 e-NAM (National Agriculture Market)

**Scheme Overview**

- Electronic trading platform connecting all agricultural mandis
- Real-time price information and transparent transactions
- Reduces intermediation and increases farmer income[5]

**Key Benefits**

- Direct access to larger national markets
- Real-time price discovery
- Transparent transactions with e-payments
- Choice among multiple buyers
- Reduced transaction costs

**Features**

- Online bidding for agricultural produce
- Coverage expanding across states
- Integration with existing APMC mandis
- Quality-based pricing system

**How to Use**

- Registration at e-NAM portal (enam.gov.in)
- Sell through registered mandis
- Access to national market prices

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## 1.8 Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana (PKVY)

**Scheme Overview**

- Organic farming promotion scheme
- Three-year cluster-based organic farming program
- Grant of ₹31,500 per hectare for clusters of 20-50 farmers[3]

**Financial Support**

- ₹15,000 per hectare directly to farmers
- ₹15,000 per hectare for certification, inputs, and marketing
- 50% of grant reaches farmers in first year

**Key Benefits**

- Certification costs reimbursed (significant cost advantage)
- Cluster approach enables collective marketing
- Access to premium organic markets
- Training in bio-pesticides and composting

**Coverage Areas**

- Suitable for all regions
- Particularly beneficial for hilly and organic-prone areas
- Integration with Jaivik Kheti (National Organic Farming) portal

**How to Apply**

- Block agriculture offices
- State agriculture departments
- NGOs implementing the scheme

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## 1.9 Agricultural Infrastructure Fund

**Scheme Overview**

- ₹1 lakh crore fund for agricultural infrastructure development
- 3% interest subvention on loans up to ₹2 crore
- Supports storage, processing, and value addition infrastructure[3]

**Eligible Infrastructure**

- Farm-gate infrastructure (storage, cold storage)
- Aggregation infrastructure
- Processing facilities
- Quality testing laboratories
- Export infrastructure

**Benefits**

- Highly subsidized interest rates (3% subvention)
- Long repayment periods
- Direct support to value chain development

**How to Apply**

- Commercial and cooperative banks
- District agriculture offices
- NABARD (National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development)

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## 1.10 Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana - RAFTAAR

**Scheme Overview**

- Holistic agricultural development scheme
- State-led grants for agricultural innovation and infrastructure
- Start-up grants up to ₹25 lakh for agri-entrepreneurs[3]

**Support Areas**

- Seed hubs and nurseries
- Custom-hiring centers for machinery
- Agri-business incubators
- Value-added processing units
- Agricultural start-ups and technology adoption

**Key Features**

- 750+ agri-start-ups supported since 2017
- 30% of funds reserved for women farmers
- Flexible funding based on state priorities
- Support for cutting-edge agri-tech solutions

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## 1.11 Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization (SMAM)

**Scheme Overview**

- Equipment and machinery support for farm mechanization
- Subsidy of 40-60% on agricultural equipment
- Custom hiring centers for machinery access[3]

**Subsidy Pattern**

- 40-50% for general farmers
- 60% for small and marginal farmers
- 50% for women farmers

**Eligible Equipment**

- Tractors and power tillers
- Threshers and harvesters
- Spraying equipment
- Seed drills and other implements

**Benefits**

- Reduced operational costs
- Increased productivity
- Equipment sharing through hiring centers
- Reduced drudgery in farming

### How to Apply

- District agriculture offices
- State agricultural departments
- Authorized dealers

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## 1.12 Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana

### Scheme Overview

- Fisheries value chain strengthening program
- Comprehensive support for aquaculture development
- Coastal area focus with modern infrastructure[1]

### Support Components

- Market linkage infrastructure
- Women-led fisheries groups
- Fish farmer producer organizations
- Processing and cold-chain infrastructure

### Key Benefits

- Enhanced fisheries production
- Employment generation in rural areas
- Export market access
- Integrated value chain development

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## 1.13 Namo-Didi Scheme (Women-focused Precision Farming)

### Scheme Overview

- Women-centered precision agriculture initiative
- Creating rural technical workforce among women
- Support for nano-fertilizer application and modern farming[2]

### Key Features

- Training for women farmers in precision agriculture
- Skill development in sustainable farming practices
- Access to advanced farming technologies
- Income generation opportunities

**Benefits**

- Addresses agricultural labor shortages
- Increases productivity through precision techniques
- Economic empowerment of rural women
- Knowledge transfer to local communities

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## 1.14 10,000 Farmer Producer Organizations (FPO) Formation Scheme

**Scheme Overview**

- Formation and support of 10,000 FPOs across India
- Collective bargaining power for small farmers
- Equity grants and credit guarantees[3]

**Financial Support**

- ₹15 lakh matching equity grant per FPO
- Credit guarantee on loans up to ₹2 crore
- Value-chain development funds

**Key Benefits**

- Improved market access and better pricing
- Economies of scale in input procurement
- Enhanced value addition and processing
- Stronger negotiating position with buyers

**How to Apply**

- SFAC (Small Farmers' Agribusiness Consortium)
- NABARD
- State agriculture departments

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# 2. RECENT GOVERNMENT INITIATIVES & NEWS

## 2.1 Budget 2026-27: Major Agricultural Focus

**Bharat Vistar - AI-Powered Multilingual Advisory Platform**

The Finance Minister announced a groundbreaking initiative in Union Budget 2026-27: Bharat Vistar, a multilingual AI tool designed to revolutionize how farmers access information and decision-making support[4][5].

**What is Bharat Vistar?**

- Multilingual AI platform integrating AgriStack portals with ICAR research
- Provides customized farming advisories in local languages
- Uses advanced AI systems for precision farming guidance
- Direct integration with existing digital farmer databases

**Key Features**

- Real-time weather and market information in local languages
- Crop-specific recommendations based on soil and climate data
- Pest and disease management guidance
- Irrigation and fertilizer optimization suggestions
- Regional context-aware advice

**Budget Allocation**

- ₹150 crore dedicated for Bharat-VISTAAR operationalization
- Integration with existing agricultural databases
- Multi-year rollout across all states

**Impact on Farmers**

- Better on-ground decision making
- Reduced crop losses through timely warnings

- Customized advice reducing chemical input costs
- Improved productivity through science-based practices

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## 2.2 Structural Shift in Agricultural Focus

**From Subsidies to Infrastructure and Value-Chain Development**

India's agricultural policy is undergoing a significant transformation, moving away from traditional subsidy models toward infrastructure, technology, and market-linked growth[2].

**Key Policy Shifts**

1. **High-Value Plantation Crops Focus**
    - Promotion of coconut, sandalwood, cashew, cocoa cultivation
    - Walnut, almond, and pine nut promotion in suitable regions
    - ₹9,000/hectare assistance for pulses
    - ₹11,500/hectare for hybrid maize
    - ₹7,500/hectare for nutritious cereals and maize
2. **Allied Sectors Growth**
    - Livestock and fisheries emerging as primary growth engines
    - Less monsoon-dependent than crop farming
    - Faster income generation
    - Employment creation in rural areas
3. **Climate-Smart Agriculture**
    - Zero Budget Natural Farming (ZBNF) promotion
    - National Mission on Natural Farming receives ₹750 crore allocation
    - Target: Coverage of 1 crore farmers for organic export market
    - Bio-Input Resource Centers at panchayat level

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## 2.3 Technology Integration in Agriculture

### AI and Digital Agriculture Transformation

Budget 2026-27 emphasizes technology-driven agricultural modernization:

### Key Initiatives

- AI-enabled precision farming advisories
- First-mile infrastructure development for post-harvest support
- Digital Farmer Card for quick access to schemes
- Online market linkages via AI-powered platforms

### Post-Harvest Infrastructure Challenge

- Farmers lose over ₹92,000 crore annually due to first-mile infrastructure gaps
- Focus on reducing post-harvest losses
- Cold-chain and logistics improvements
- Integration of ports and warehousing infrastructure

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## 2.4 Import Substitution and Self-Reliance Goals

### Focus Areas for 2026

1. **Edible Oil Self-Reliance**
    - Strategic concern due to price volatility
    - Increased oilseed cultivation support
    - Processing infrastructure development
2. **Pulses Production**
    - 100% MSP procurement planned for major pulse crops
    - Area expansion and productivity increase
    - Reduction in import dependence
3. **Spices and Specialty Crops**
    - Sandalwood cultivation revival in partnership with states
    - Post-harvest processing improvements
    - Export-oriented production

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## 2.5 Expected Changes to Major Schemes in 2026

**PM Kisan Samman Nidhi Enhancement**

- Discussions underway to increase annual amount from ₹6,000 to ₹8,000-₹10,000
- Additional support to manage rising input costs
- Special focus on small and marginal farmers[1]

**Fasal Bima Yojana Simplification**

- Faster claim settlement processes
- Weather-based insurance system strengthening
- Improved compensation distribution
- Reduced documentation requirements

**MSP and Price Stabilization**

- Stronger Minimum Support Price (MSP) guarantees
- Expanded procurement for pulses, oilseeds, and coarse grains
- Price stabilization fund under discussion
- Protection from market fluctuations

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# 3. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQs)

## 3.1 General Agriculture Questions

**Q1: How far is it true that Indian economy is an agrarian economy?**

**Ans:** India continues to have a significant agricultural base with approximately 46.1% workforce engaged in agriculture (as per PLFS 2023-24). Agriculture contributes substantially to national income and provides livelihoods to over 50% of rural population. While economic diversification is ongoing, agriculture remains fundamental to Indian economy[6].

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**Q2: What are the causes of low agricultural productivity in India?**

**Ans:** Major factors include:

- Inadequate irrigation infrastructure
- Insufficient use of high-yielding varieties (HYV) seeds
- Limited use of chemical fertilizers and modern inputs
- Traditional farming methods and outdated technologies
- Small and fragmented landholdings
- Inadequate access to quality credit
- Poor post-harvest infrastructure
- Limited market access and linkages
- Water scarcity and groundwater depletion
- Climate variability and extreme weather events[6]

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**Q3: What measures can improve agricultural productivity?**

**Ans:** Recommended measures include:

- Expansion of irrigation infrastructure and water management systems
- Extensive adoption of HYV seeds and improved crop varieties
- Precision use of fertilizers and biofertilizers
- Modern agricultural techniques including mechanization
- Implementation of crop rotation and mixed farming
- Prevention of land erosion through conservation practices
- Easy access to agricultural credit at subsidized rates
- Market linkage and e-commerce platforms for direct sales
- Training and capacity building for farmers
- Climate-smart and sustainable agriculture practices
- Technology adoption (drones, AI, IoT sensors)[6]

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**Q4: What are the branches of agriculture?**

**Ans:** Major branches include:

- Field crop production (cereals, pulses, oilseeds)
- Horticulture (fruits, vegetables, spices)
- Forestry and agroforestry
- Animal husbandry (cattle, buffaloes, poultry)

- Dairy farming
- Fisheries and aquaculture
- Sericulture (silk production)
- Apiculture (bee farming)
- Organic farming and natural farming
- Plantation agriculture (tea, coffee, rubber)
- Allied agriculture (mushroom cultivation, herbs)
- Agribusiness and value addition[6]

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## 3.2 Soil and Crop Management FAQs

**Q5: How do I keep the soil healthy?**

**Ans:** Key practices for soil health:

- Conduct regular soil testing through Soil Health Card scheme (free service)
- Apply organic matter and compost regularly to improve soil structure
- Practice crop rotation to maintain nutrient balance
- Avoid excessive chemical fertilizer use based on soil test recommendations
- Implement mulching to conserve moisture and prevent erosion
- Use biofertilizers and biopesticides where suitable
- Maintain proper field drainage to prevent waterlogging
- Avoid continuous cultivation of same crop
- Incorporate crop residues and legume crops
- Control soil erosion through bunding and terracing
- Regular monitoring for soil-borne diseases[6]

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**Q6: Why is crop rotation important?**

**Ans:** Crop rotation benefits include:

- **Soil Fertility**: Legume crops fix nitrogen, replenishing soil nutrients
- **Soil Structure**: Different root depths and residues improve soil structure
- **Pest and Disease Control**: Breaks pest and disease cycles specific to crops

- **Weed Management**: Different crops require different weeding patterns
- **Water Use**: Different crops use water differently, optimizing use
- **Reduced Chemical Input**: Lower pest pressure reduces pesticide needs
- **Improved Yields**: Rotated crops generally show better productivity
- **Sustainable Farming**: Reduces environmental impact and input costs
- **Microbial Diversity**: Encourages beneficial soil microorganisms
- **Nitrogen Economy**: Reduces nitrogen fertilizer requirement by 20-30%[6]

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**Q7: What factors affect crop production?**

**Ans:** Major factors influencing crop yield:

- **Soil Fertility**: Adequate NPK and micronutrients essential
- **Water Availability**: Proper irrigation and rainfall crucial
- **Climatic Conditions**: Temperature, humidity, wind patterns
- **Sunlight Intensity**: Adequate light hours for photosynthesis
- **Seed Quality**: Use of certified HYV seeds
- **Pest and Disease Incidence**: Regular monitoring and control
- **Weed Competition**: Timely weeding essential
- **Nutrient Management**: Balanced fertilizer application
- **Timely Operations**: Sowing, application, harvesting at right time
- **Farm Management Practices**: Crop variety selection, spacing, intercropping
- **Labor Availability**: Timely availability of farm workers
- **Market Access**: Fair prices and timely sale opportunities[6]

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## 3.3 Agricultural Schemes FAQs

**Q8: Who is eligible for PM Kisan Samman Nidhi?**

**Ans:** Eligibility criteria for PM Kisan:

- Must be an Indian citizen
- Farmer with cultivable land ownership or valid lease agreement

- Small and marginal farmer category (preferred but not mandatory)
- Must have valid Aadhaar linked to active bank account
- Must complete e-KYC verification
- Family-based eligibility (only one person per landholding receives benefit)

**NOT Eligible:**

- Income tax payers
- Government employees (especially those drawing higher salaries)
- Institutional landholders
- Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)
- Farmers with large landholdings (in some states)
- Those not completing mandatory e-KYC registration[7]

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**Q9: How do I apply for Crop Insurance (PMFBY)?**

**Ans:** Application process for PMFBY:

1. **Online Registration**: Visit pmfby.gov.in or state portal
2. **Through Banks**: Apply at time of taking crop loan
3. **CSC Centers**: Register through nearest Common Service Center
4. **Insurance Agents**: Direct registration with authorized agents

**Documents Required:**

- Land ownership proof
- Identification documents
- Bank account details
- Aadhar card
- Mobile number for SMS updates

**Application Timing:**

- Kharif: Apply before June 30
- Rabi: Apply before December 31
- Application within 10 days of sowing recommended

**Claim Process:**

- Inform insurance company immediately after crop loss
- Provide evidence of damage
- Wait for field officer's assessment
- Claim payout within specified period[7]

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**Q10: How can I get a Kisan Credit Card (KCC)?**

**Ans:** KCC application process:

1. **Visit Your Bank**: Approach public/private/cooperative bank branch
2. **Submit Application**: Fill KCC form with required documents
3. **Land Verification**: Bank verifies landholding
4. **Loan Assessment**: Bank determines credit limit based on landholding
5. **Document Submission**: Submit all required documents
6. **Approval and Issuance**: Card issued after approval

**Documents Needed:**

- Aadhar card
- PAN card
- Land ownership proof
- Bank account statement (6 months)
- Passport size photographs
- Address proof

**Benefits:**

- Revolving credit facility
- Effective interest rate ~4% with subsidy
- Coverage for seeds, fertilizers, pesticides, labor
- Coverage for allied activities (dairy, fisheries)

**How to Use:**

- KCC can be used multiple times
- Limit resets annually after harvest
- Flexible repayment as per crop harvest cycle[7]

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**Q11: How do I access e-NAM (National Agriculture Market)?**

**Ans:** Steps to use e-NAM:

1. **Registration**: Go to enam.gov.in
2. **Create Account**: Register as seller/buyer
3. **Complete e-KYC**: Submit required documents
4. **Mandi Selection**: Choose nearest participating mandi
5. **List Produce**: Upload details of agricultural produce
6. **Bidding**: Participate in online bidding
7. **Transaction**: Complete sale through platform
8. **Payment**: Receive payment through digital transfer

**Advantages Over Traditional Mandis:**

- Real-time price information
- Transparent bidding process
- Access to national market
- Reduced intermediaries and costs
- Direct payment to account
- Better prices through competitive bidding
- SMS updates on market prices[5]

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**Q12: How do I register for Soil Health Card Scheme?**

**Ans:** Registration and testing process:

1. **Contact District Office**: Approach District Agriculture Office
2. **Provide Land Details**: Provide village, field, and soil type information
3. **Sample Collection**: Soil samples collected by trained officers
4. **Laboratory Testing**: Testing for NPK and micronutrients
5. **Report Generation**: Card generated with test results and recommendations
6. **Card Distribution**: Card issued to farmer with guidelines

**What Information is Provided:**

- Soil pH level
- Nitrogen (N) content
- Phosphorus (P) content
- Potassium (K) content
- Sulfur (S) content

- Zinc (Zn) and other micronutrients
- Crop-wise fertilizer recommendations
- Organic matter percentage

**Cost**: Completely free service
**Frequency**: Recommended every 2-3 years for updated recommendations[3]

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**Q13: What is Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana (PKVY)?**

**Ans:** PKVY scheme for organic farming:

- Three-year cluster-based organic farming program
- Clusters consist of 20-50 farmers in 2-4 hectare land each
- Total grant: ₹31,500 per hectare over 3 years
- Direct farmer benefit: ₹15,000 per hectare
- Additional benefit: ₹15,000 per hectare for certification and inputs

**Coverage Includes:**

- Organic certification costs
- Bio-inputs (bio-fertilizers, bio-pesticides)
- Composting units
- Vermicomposting pits
- Training programs

**Eligibility:**

- Willingness to switch to organic farming
- Land with 3-4 year transition possible
- Suitable soil and climatic conditions
- Commitment to cluster approach

**How to Apply:**

- Block agriculture offices
- State agriculture departments
- NGOs implementing the scheme
- Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs)[3]

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# 3.4 Agricultural Technology and Practices FAQs

**Q14: What is precision farming and how can it benefit me?**

**Ans:** Precision farming utilizes technology for optimized agricultural practices:

- Use of GPS, drones, and sensors for field mapping
- Soil-specific and zone-specific input application
- Reduced fertilizer and water usage by 20-40%
- Increased productivity by 15-30%
- Lower environmental impact
- Real-time crop monitoring through IoT sensors
- Data-driven decision making for pest and disease management

**Benefits:**

- Significant cost reduction through input optimization
- Higher yields with same resources
- Sustainable farming practices
- Better soil and water conservation
- Compliance with environmental standards

**Available Government Support:**

- Bharat Vistar AI platform providing precision recommendations
- Subsidies available under various schemes for equipment
- Training programs through Krishi Vigyan Kendras

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**Q15: What is Zero Budget Natural Farming (ZBNF)?**

**Ans:** ZBNF is a sustainable farming approach with minimal external input costs:

- Uses on-farm resources for inputs
- Preparation of natural fertilizers and pesticides locally
- Composting and vermicomposting for soil nutrient
- Cow dung and urine-based preparations (Panchagavya, Jivamrit)
- Reduced dependence on chemical inputs

- Lower farming costs through local resource utilization

**Advantages:**

- Drastic reduction in input costs (50-70% reduction)
- Improved soil health and soil microbial activity
- Organic produce with premium market value
- Environmental sustainability
- Long-term soil fertility improvement

**Government Support:**

- ₹750 crore allocation under National Mission on Natural Farming
- Target of 1 crore farmer coverage
- Bio-Input Resource Centers at panchayat level
- Training programs through state agriculture departments[2]

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**Q16: What is Integrated Pest Management (IPM)?**

**Ans:** IPM is a holistic approach combining multiple pest control methods:

- Cultural practices (crop rotation, intercropping)
- Biological control (parasitoids, predators, beneficial insects)
- Physical methods (traps, netting, hand-picking)
- Chemical methods (as last resort)
- Monitoring and threshold-based interventions

**IPM Advantages:**

- Reduced pesticide use by 50-70%
- Lower cost through optimized chemical use
- Environmental safety and reduced chemical residues
- Sustainable pest control
- Better quality produce
- Maintenance of beneficial insect populations

**Common IPM Techniques:**

- Light traps for insect monitoring
- Pheromone traps for early detection

- Bird perches to encourage natural predators
- Companion planting and intercropping
- Scheduled spraying based on pest threshold
- Use of bio-pesticides (Beauveria, Trichoderma)[8]

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# 4. AGRICULTURAL ADVISORIES, WARNINGS & PRECAUTIONS

## 4.1 Current Weather-Based Advisories (February 2026)

**General Agromet Advisories**

**For All Farmers:**

- Monitor crops regularly for fungal diseases and pest infestation
- Take timely control measures based on expert recommendations
- Avoid irrigation and pesticide spraying during foggy mornings
- Avoid spraying during thunderstorm days
- Ensure proper field drainage to prevent waterlogging
- Stake or support vegetable and horticultural crops against wind damage
- Harvest mature crops during clear weather to maintain quality[9][10]

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**Safety Precautions:**

- Farmers and field workers must avoid open fields during thunderstorms
- Do not stand near tall trees during lightning events
- Stay alert for weather warnings from IMD
- Follow local administration advisories
- Download DAMINI app for lightning early warnings
- Keep animals in protective sheds during adverse weather

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## 4.2 Crop-Specific Advisories

**Wheat Crops**

- Monitor for aphids, termites, and leaf yellowing
- If yellowing observed, spray zinc sulphate and urea solution
- Avoid excessive irrigation in late-sown wheat
- Plant protection measures for termites using recommended chemicals
- Monitor fungal disease risk during cloudy weather[9]

**Chickpea and Pulses**

- Monitor continuously for caterpillar infestation
- Use bird perches (20 ft spacing) for natural pest control
- Deploy light traps and pheromone traps for early detection
- Watch for powdery mildew during cloudy weather
- Inspect regularly and take timely control measures[9]

**Cotton**

- Monitor for root rot infection
- Spot drench with carbendazim for root rot control
- Watch for boll worm infestation
- Early pest detection using pheromone traps
- Maintain field sanitation

**Rice**

- Monitor for stem borer and leaf folder infestation
- Spray Chlorantraniliprole 18.5% (150 ml/ha) if symptoms observed
- Maintain proper water levels
- Monitor for fungal diseases[10]

**Vegetables (Tomato, Chilli, Brinjal)**

- Monitor for fruit borer infestation
- Spray Indoxacarb 14.5 SC @ 0.5 ml/liter if borers detected
- For sucking pests: Spray Thiamethoxam @ 7g per pump
- Remove and destroy virus-infected plants (rouging)
- Provide adequate support/staking to prevent lodging

- Harvest on time and market promptly[10]

**Garlic and Ginger**

- Stop irrigation in mature crops
- Harvest at proper stage
- Ensure proper grading before marketing
- Watch for fungal diseases during high humidity[10]

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## 4.3 Disease Management Guidelines

**Common Fungal Diseases and Control:**

**Powdery Mildew** (Affects grapes, wheat, pulses, vegetables)

- Symptoms: White fungal coating on leaves and fruits
- Monitoring: Inspect regularly during humid conditions
- Control: Spray sulfur-based fungicides or bio-fungicides
- Prevention: Ensure proper plant spacing and air circulation

**Blast Disease** (Rice)

- Symptoms: Leaf spots, neck rot, panicle blight
- Risk Period: High humidity and cool temperatures
- Control: Use resistant varieties, spray fungicides if required
- Prevention: Proper field sanitation and removal of infected plants

**Rust Diseases** (Wheat, Pulses)

- Symptoms: Yellow-orange pustules on leaves
- Severity: Depends on variety susceptibility and weather
- Control: Spray recommended fungicides
- Prevention: Use rust-resistant varieties
- Monitoring: Regular scouting of crops[9]

**Blight Diseases** (Potato, Tomato)

- Symptoms: Water-soaked spots, rapid leaf and fruit decay
- Conditions: High humidity, cool nights favor disease
- Control: Improve drainage, spray copper/mancozeb fungicides
- Prevention: Use disease-free seed

**Wilt Diseases** (Tomato, Banana)

- Symptoms: Yellowing and wilting of leaves
- Cause: Soil-borne fungal pathogens
- Control: Use resistant varieties, soil sterilization
- Prevention: Crop rotation, resistant rootstocks

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## 4.4 Pest Management Guidelines

**Major Pests and Control Measures:**

**Stem Borer** (Rice, Sugarcane)

- Symptoms: Dead hearts in rice, withered plants
- Monitoring: Regular field inspection
- Control: Spray Chlorantraniliprole or use pheromone traps
- Cultural: Remove infected crop parts, field sanitation

**Leaf Folder** (Rice)

- Symptoms: Rolled leaves, reduced photosynthesis
- Monitoring: Check leaf rolling frequency
- Control: Spray recommended pesticides
- Natural Control: Use parasitoid wasps (Tetrastichus)

**Bollworm** (Cotton)

- Symptoms: Boll damage, seed loss
- Monitoring: Use pheromone traps (20 traps/acre)
- Control: Spray Indoxacarb or Emamectin benzoate
- Prevention: Remove infected bolls, field sanitation

**Fruit Borer** (Vegetables, Okra)

- Symptoms: Holes in fruits, internal rot
- Control: Remove infested fruits, spray Emamectin benzoate
- Cultural: Destroy crop residues, crop rotation

**Aphids** (Multiple crops)

- Symptoms: Leaf curling, yellowing, honeydew secretion
- Control: Spray Thiamethoxam or Imidacloprid

- Natural Control: Encourage parasitoid wasps (Diaeretiella)
- Monitoring: Monitor before spray, reduce if population drops

**Whitefly** (Cotton, Vegetables)

- Symptoms: Yellowing leaves, virus transmission
- Control: Spray neem oil or yellow sticky traps
- Prevention: Remove infected plant parts
- Monitoring: Track population using sticky traps[8]

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## 4.5 Livestock and Poultry Advisories

**General Livestock Care:**

**Cold Weather Precautions:**

- Keep cattle in proper, covered shelters with roofing
- Provide warm bedding (dry straw, paddy straw)
- Use 100-200W bulbs for night heating in severe cold
- Mix jaggery and ajwain in feed for warmth
- Provide dry and nutritious feed with adequate energy content[9][10]

**Health Management:**

- Provide adequate clean drinking water (even in cold season)
- Maintain animals in dry conditions
- Protect from wind and rain exposure
- Ensure proper ventilation in sheds
- Use smoke to reduce mosquitoes and insect nuisance
- Prevent tick and parasite infestation

**Fodder Management:**

- Harvest green fodder (Berseem, Rizka) before flowering for better nutrition
- Feed mixed dry and green fodder
- Ensure adequate leguminous fodder for protein
- Apply recommended fertilizers to fodder crops
- Provide mineral-rich supplements

**Young Animal Care:**

- Protect newborn calves from cold using straw bedding
- Keep young animals separated initially
- Monitor for disease symptoms
- Ensure adequate colostrum feeding
- Prevent infection through sanitation

**Poultry Care:**

- Cover poultry sheds with jute sacks during cold
- Use heat bulbs (200-watt) for 5-6 hours at night
- Supplement feed with vitamins and minerals
- Ensure proper ventilation without drafts
- Maintain strict biosecurity measures[9]

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## 4.6 Pest and Disease Loss Prevention

**Expected Crop Loss Without Management:**

- Farmers lose 15-25% of potential crop yield annually due to pests and diseases[11]
- Timely management can reduce losses by over 50%

**Prevention Strategy:**

1. **Regular Monitoring**: Weekly field inspections during growing season
2. **Early Detection**: Use of traps, regular crop scouting
3. **Threshold-Based Intervention**: Spray only when pest population exceeds economic threshold
4. **Biological Control**: Encourage natural enemies
5. **Prophylactic Measures**: Remove crop residues, practice crop rotation
6. **Resistant Varieties**: Use disease/pest-resistant crop varieties

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## 4.7 Water and Irrigation Advisories

**Optimal Irrigation Practices:**

- Irrigate fields in evening or early morning to minimize frost impact
- Apply irrigation as per crop requirement and soil moisture status
- Avoid overwatering during high humidity and cool weather
- Provide light irrigation at 20-day intervals in winter
- Ensure proper drainage in fields to prevent waterlogging[9]

**Groundwater Conservation:**

- Use drip and sprinkler irrigation systems for efficiency
- Avoid excessive groundwater depletion
- Adopt water-saving techniques
- Monitor water table levels
- Consider shift to less water-intensive crops

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## 4.8 Fertilizer and Input Application Guidelines

**Chemical Application Safety:**

- Broadcast urea only when sufficient soil moisture available
- Ensure leaves are dry before fertilizer application
- Avoid fertilizer/pesticide spraying during foggy mornings
- Do not spray during thunderstorms or high wind
- Wear protective equipment (masks, gloves) during application
- Wash equipment after use to prevent chemical buildup

**Rodent Control:**

- Use Zinc phosphide mixed with bait in rat-infested areas
- Restrict water availability for 3-4 days during treatment
- Remove crop residues that harbor rodents
- Use snap traps as supplementary control[9]

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## 4.9 Important Contact Numbers and Resources

**Government Agricultural Services:**

- **Agricultural Help Line**: 1917 (iTEAM service)
- **Weather Alerts**: Download DAMINI app for lightning warnings
- **Agricultural Advisories**: Contact local Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK)
- **Scheme Information**: Visit state agriculture department websites

**Recommended Apps:**

- DAMINI App: Lightning and thunderstorm warnings
- e-NAM App: Market prices and agricultural trading
- PM-KISAN App: Scheme status and payment tracking
- Bharat Vistar: Multilingual farming advisories (launching 2026)

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# 5. SEASONAL PRECAUTIONS FOR FEBRUARY-MARCH 2026

## 5.1 Winter Crops (Rabi) - Maturation Phase

**Crop Status:**

- Most rabi crops (wheat, pulses, mustard) in flowering to fruit formation stage
- Maturation phase approaching
- Weather conditions: Cool mornings with warm days

**Key Precautions:**

- Monitor for pest activity increase as temperatures moderate
- Watch for powdery mildew during humid days
- Avoid irrigation unless critical
- Monitor for nutrient deficiencies (yellowing of leaves)
- Prepare harvesting equipment

- Plan for timely harvest during dry weather windows

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## 5.2 Summer Preparation

**Crop Planning:**

- Select suitable summer crops based on water availability
- Arrange adequate irrigation infrastructure
- Consider heat-tolerant varieties
- Plan pest and disease management
- Arrange marketing linkages

**Field Preparation:**

- Plan crop rotation for next season
- Arrange seeds and inputs in advance
- Test soil and apply recommended amendments
- Plan for mulching to conserve moisture
- Arrange laborers well in advance

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## 5.3 Critical Weather Monitoring

**Risks to Monitor:**

- Late-season frost in northern plains
- Unseasonal rainfall damaging ripe crops
- Hailstorms and wind damage to mature crops
- Extreme temperature fluctuations
- Dry winds affecting flowering crops

**Protective Measures:**

- Cover vulnerable crops during frost forecasts
- Ensure field drainage is functional
- Stake tall crops against wind damage
- Monitor weather forecasts regularly
- Have contingency plans for crop loss

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# 6. CONTACT INFORMATION & RESOURCES

## 6.1 Government Portals and Websites

**Official Scheme Portals:**

- PM-KISAN: www.pmkisan.gov.in
- PM Fasal Bima Yojana: www.pmfby.gov.in
- e-NAM: www.enam.gov.in
- Soil Health Card: soil.nic.in
- PM KUSUM: kusum.mnre.gov.in

**State Agriculture Departments:**

- Maharashtra: agriscan.maha.gov.in
- Punjab: agritech.tnau.ac.in
- Uttar Pradesh: agriculture.up.gov.in
- Madhya Pradesh: megagriculture.gov.in
- Refer to your state agriculture department website

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## 6.2 Important Contact Numbers

- **Agricultural Helpline**: 1917 (ITEAM service)
- **Emergency Weather Alerts**: Download DAMINI app
- **Local Agriculture Office**: Contact Block/District Agriculture Officer
- **Krishi Vigyan Kendra**: Nearest KVK in your block

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## 6.3 Key Government Agencies

- **ICAR** (Indian Council of Agricultural Research): www.icar.org.in
- **NABARD** (National Bank for Agriculture): www.nabard.org
- **DAC** (Department of Agriculture & Cooperation): dac.gov.in
- **IMD** (India Meteorological Department): imd.gov.in
- **SFAC** (Small Farmers' Agribusiness Consortium): www.sfacindia.com

# 7. KEY TAKEAWAYS FOR FARMERS

## 7.1 Priority Actions for 2026

1. **Update Digital Records**
    - Complete e-KYC for PM-Kisan registration
    - Update bank account details
    - Register Farmer ID on government portals
2. **Maximize Scheme Benefits**
    - Register for PM-KISAN to receive annual ₹6,000
    - Enroll in Fasal Bima Yojana for crop insurance
    - Get Soil Health Card for free soil testing
    - Apply for KCC for affordable credit
3. **Technology Adoption**
    - Register with e-NAM for better market prices
    - Use Bharat Vistar app for farming advisories
    - Monitor weather alerts through DAMINI app
    - Access market information regularly
4. **Pest and Disease Management**
    - Monitor crops regularly (weekly inspection)
    - Implement Integrated Pest Management (IPM)
    - Use bio-pesticides and natural controls
    - Follow government advisories for timing of interventions
5. **Sustainable Practices**
    - Test soil before fertilizer application
    - Practice crop rotation
    - Conserve water through drip/sprinkler irrigation
    - Consider organic farming or ZBNF for long-term sustainability

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## 7.2 Upcoming Scheme Enhancements

- **PM-Kisan amount increase** expected (₹8,000-₹10,000)
- **Bharat Vistar AI platform** launch for local language advisories
- **Faster crop insurance** claim settlements

- **MSP expansion** for pulses and oilseeds
- **Bio-Input Resource Centers** creation at panchayat level

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## 7.3 Resources for Continuous Learning

- **Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs)**: Free training and advisory
- **CSC Centers**: Scheme registration and support
- **Government WhatsApp Groups**: Regular agricultural updates
- **Agro-Advisory Bulletins**: Weekly weather-based recommendations
- **Farmer Helplines**: 1917 and state-specific numbers

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**Document Prepared**: February 2026
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**For**: Indian Farmers seeking comprehensive information on schemes, news, FAQs, and agricultural advisories

**Disclaimer**: This document is compiled from official government sources and agricultural research institutions. Farmers should verify specific details with their local agriculture department or official portals before applying for schemes or implementing recommendations.

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*This comprehensive guide aims to empower Indian farmers with accessible, up-to-date information about government support systems, best practices, and critical agricultural knowledge for 2026.*